



## **INSTRUCTIONAL AREA**

### Promotion

## **RETAIL MERCHANDISING SERIES EVENT**

### **PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS**

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21<sup>st</sup> Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

### **21<sup>st</sup> CENTURY SKILLS**

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- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

### **PERFORMANCE INDICATORS**

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1. Explain the nature of a promotional plan.
2. Explain the role of promotion as a marketing function.
3. Explain the concept of marketing strategies.
4. Build and maintain relationships with customers.
5. Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.

## EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the **MARKETING MANAGER** for **URBAN NEST**, a home décor and furniture retailer. The **OWNER** of the company (judge) wants you to create a promotional plan to launch a new line of eco-friendly products aimed at college students and young professionals.

**URBAN NEST** has successfully operated for 15 years, catering primarily to established homeowners with higher price-point furniture. However, sales data indicates a significant gap in customers aged 18–25. To capture this market, the store is launching "The Green Dorm," a collection of sustainable, affordable, and space-saving furniture and décor items designed for dorms and first apartments.

The collection will hit the sales floor in four weeks, just in time for the "Back to School" shopping season. The **OWNER** (judge) is concerned that the store's current image is too "stuffy" for this younger demographic and that the current customer base will not be interested in these lower-priced items.

The **OWNER** (judge) has asked you to develop a promotional plan specifically for the "The Green Dorm" launch. The owner wants the plan to accomplish two goals: drive foot traffic from the new younger demographic and utilize digital engagement.

Your plan must include:

- Identification of the specific target market behaviors.
- A social media strategy to build hype before the launch.
- A concept for an in-store kick-off event.
- One promotional partnership idea with a local business or campus organization.

You will present your ideas to the **OWNER** (judge) in a role-play to take place in the **OWNER'S** office. The **OWNER** (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and have answered the **OWNER'S** questions, the **OWNER** (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How can we ensure our current, high-end customers do not feel alienated by this lower-priced product line?
2. What metrics will you use to determine if the social media campaign is actually driving sales, rather than just "likes"?

| Did the participant:          |                                                                                         | Novice  | Developing | Proficient | Exemplary | Judged Score |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------|------------|-----------|--------------|
| <b>PERFORMANCE INDICATORS</b> |                                                                                         |         |            |            |           |              |
| 1.                            | Explain the nature of a promotional plan?                                               | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7    | 8-9        | 10        |              |
| 2.                            | Explain the role of promotion as a marketing function?                                  | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7    | 8-9        | 10        |              |
| 3.                            | Explain the concept of marketing strategies?                                            | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7    | 8-9        | 10        |              |
| 4.                            | Build and maintain relationships with customers.                                        | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7    | 8-9        | 10        |              |
| 5.                            | Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior?                | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7    | 8-9        | 10        |              |
| <b>SOLUTION</b>               |                                                                                         |         |            |            |           |              |
| 6.                            | Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach. | 0-1-2   | 3-4-5      | 6-7        | 8         |              |
| 7.                            | Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.                                   | 0-1-2   | 3-4-5      | 6-7        | 8         |              |
| 8.                            | Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.                                                  | 0-1-2   | 3-4-5      | 6-7        | 8         |              |
| <b>CAREER COMPETENCIES</b>    |                                                                                         |         |            |            |           |              |
| 9.                            | Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.                  | 0-1     | 2-3        | 4-5        | 6         |              |
| 10.                           | Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.                      | 0-1     | 2-3        | 4-5        | 6         |              |
| 11.                           | Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.                                    | 0-1     | 2-3        | 4-5        | 6         |              |
| <b>OVERALL IMPRESSION</b>     |                                                                                         |         |            |            |           |              |
| 12.                           | Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.   | 0-1-2   | 3-4-5      | 6-7        | 8         |              |
| <b>TOTAL SCORE</b>            |                                                                                         |         |            |            |           |              |